Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction
- ✓ Introduction to Module 1
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artistic Equivalents
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
- ✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
- ✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
- ✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Moon Phases
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction
- ○ **Introduction to Module 3**
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
- ○ Facts and Fictions
  Reading • 6 min
- ○ Fictions and Facts
  Reading • 6 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996
  Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
- ○ Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange
  Reading • 4 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
- ○ Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents
  Video • 3 min
- ○ New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand
  Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Introduction to Module 3

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Documents and the Documentary

Because of photography's inextricable connection to the real world—light sensitive film records what is before the camera's lens—many descriptive photographs are considered documents, and the mode of making them is often called "documentary." In this module, we will explore work by many different makers across eras that have engaged with this idea to help build an appreciation for just how complicated it can be. Generations of photographers have turned their cameras to the world around them with the aim of taking pictures that record, remember, or bear witness. In the twentieth century, many photographers made images in the service of larger social causes. Newspapers and magazines came to rely on photographic illustrations to underscore the meaning of their stories and, conversely, text was called upon to shape viewers' understanding of what they were seeing.

By the 1960s, many photographers began to feel constrained by the editorial control imposed by the popular press. They sought other outlets for sharing their work including publishing their own books. This coincided with the emergence of documentary projects that were intentionally inflected with personal meaning, made to question and subvert the perceived truthfulness of the medium or call attention to its political, social, and ethical complexities. Today, photographers continue to use the camera as a means of documenting the world, acknowledging that their images are not fixed statements of fact but, rather, that they may be read and interpreted in many different ways.

Learning Objectives

- Analyze the reliability of photographs and the ways photographers reveal, manipulate, and critique truth.
- Examine how words in and around photographs impact our understanding of them.
- Compare the ways photographers have used the documentary style for personal expression and in service to larger social causes.

Mark as completed

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